Project Design Phase
Problem – Solution Fit Template

Date	30 October 2026
Team ID	
Project Name	Automated Network Request Management
Maximum Marks	2 Marks

Problem – Solution Fit Template:

The Problem-Solution Fit simply means that you have found a problem with your customer and that the solution you have realized for it actually solves the customer's problem. It helps entrepreneurs, marketers and corporate innovators identify behavioral patterns and recognize what would work and why.

Purpose:

- Solve complex problems in a way that fits the state of your customers.
- Succeed faster and increase your solution adoption by tapping into existing mediums and channels of behavior.
- Sharpen your communication and marketing strategy with the right triggers and messaging.
- Increase touch-points with your company by finding the right problem-behavior fit and building trust by solving frequent annoyances, or urgent or costly problems.
- **Understand the existing situation in order to improve it for your target group.**

Template:

The completed Problem – Solution Fit canvas for **Automated Network Request Management** is given on the next page (Figure 1).

Problem–solution fit in brief

Problem: network service requests handled without structure lead to incomplete information, manual approvals, unclear tracking and no timely notices. **Fit:** the ServiceNow application gives requesters a structured catalog form with conditional validation, links each request to an approval and a task, and sends an acknowledgement and a resolution email, which addresses each root cause in the canvas.

Basis and limitations: the canvas is based on analysis of the project and on development-instance testing. No customer interviews or surveys were carried out, so behaviours and emotions are assumptions to validate with real users. Task creation is currently a manual step, and an Outbox state of Ready does not prove inbox delivery.

References:

1. https://www.ideahackers.network/problem-solution-fit-canvas/
2. https://medium.com/@epicantus/problem-solution-fit-canvas-aa3dd59cb4fe

Figure 1: Problem – Solution Fit canvas for Automated Network Request Management

Define CS, fit into CC

1. CUSTOMER SEGMENT(S) — CS

- Requesters: employees and other users who need a new or existing network connection or a related network service.
- Approvers: for example the System Administrator, who decide on requests.
- Network Team members who carry out the work.
- Administrators who maintain the application.

6. CUSTOMER CONSTRAINTS — CC

- Users must know which details a request needs (mobile number, connection type, amount, payment mode, address; Existing ID for existing connections).
- Approval depends on an approver being available.
- Users need access to the ServiceNow Service Portal and a working email set-up.
- The prototype runs in a developer instance, not a production environment.

5. AVAILABLE SOLUTIONS — AS

- Typical alternatives (not from a user study): requests by email, phone or message; spreadsheets; manual approval by forwarding messages.
- Pros: quick to start, no set-up. Cons: incomplete details, repeated entry, hard to track, no linked approval or task records.
- Differentiate: dedicated network request form, conditional Existing ID, flow-based approval, task tracking and two emails in one platform.

Explore AS, differentiate

Focus on J&P, tap into BE, understand RC

2. JOBS-TO-BE-DONE / PROBLEMS — J&P

- Requester: submit a complete network request quickly and know it was received.
- Approver: decide on a request with its details in front of them.
- Network Team: know which task belongs to which request and mark it complete.
- Requester: be told when the request is resolved.

9. PROBLEM ROOT CAUSE — RC

- Request details are collected without a structured form, so information is missing and entered repeatedly.
- Approvals and tasks are handled manually without linked records, causing delays and unclear responsibility.
- No automatic acknowledgement or resolution message, so users are unsure of progress.
- Inconsistent checking of submitted information.

7. BEHAVIOUR — BE

- Typical current behaviour (assumed, not surveyed): users send details by email, phone or chat and later ask for status updates.
- Approvers respond when they notice a request.
- Users already use web portals and email, so a portal form plus email notices fits existing habits.

Focus on J&P, tap into BE, understand RC

Identify strong TR & EM

3. TRIGGERS — TR

- A user needs a new network connection or a change to an existing one.
- Receiving the request-created email prompts the requester to note the request number.
- An approval request prompts the approver to act.
- Work Status = Completed triggers the resolution email.

4. EMOTIONS: BEFORE / AFTER — EM

- Before: uncertain whether the request arrived, frustrated by repeated entry and chasing.
- After (intended, not measured): more confident, with a request number, a two business working day timeframe and a resolution notice.

10. YOUR SOLUTION — SL

- A ServiceNow scoped low-code application built in App Engine Studio.
- Network Request catalog item in the Service Portal (/sp): required fields, Existing ID shown only for Existing connections, requester details auto-populated.
- Network Request flow: creates a Database Tables record, sends 'Request has been Created', asks for approval and updates Approved or Rejected.
- Network Task Table tracks Work Status (task records are created manually).
- Network Task Completion Email flow sends 'Request has been Resolved'.
- Limits: prototype; rejection branch not freshly tested; Outbox state Ready shows the email was queued, not delivered.

8.1 ONLINE — CH

- Service Portal (/sp) catalog item.
- Emails generated by the flows (viewed in the ServiceNow Outbox).
- Approval records and related list in ServiceNow.

8.2 OFFLINE — CH

- No offline channel is built into the application.
- Phone, paper or spreadsheet habits are what the solution aims to replace; an offline channel is outside the current scope.

Extract online & offline CH of BE